

Join the Space Station Word Search!

Find the words listed below in the puzzle on the next page! Then check your Word Search solution against the answer key, and read about what they mean in the special language of life on the Station!

AIRLOCK - The special module that astronauts use to enter and leave the Space Station for spacewalks (see QUEST)

ASTRONAUT - The American word for space traveler

ATV - Automated Transfer Vehicle; the European spaceship that is designed to bring supplies and fuel to the Station

[] - Mystery entry for you to research: Slang term for the Japanese External Facility, where outside experiments are done (Hint: Sounds like a backyard-facing extension of a country house where folks might sit on rocking chairs and talk about the research being done on the Space Station...)

CANADA ARM - Canada's giant robotic arm ...makes sense, eh? Called 'Canadarm2' for short (the first Canadarm flew on the Shuttle)

COLUMBUS - Name given to Europe's laboratory module, in honor of Christopher Columbus

COSMONAUT - The Russian word for space traveler

CSA - The short form of 'Canadian Space Agency'

CUPOLA - Station's special windowed room with very clear glass so astronauts and instruments can see Earth and space

CYGNUS - American cargo spaceship designed to bring supplies to Station

DESTINY - Name given to America's laboratory module, which also controls most of Station's functions (see 'US Lab')

DRAGON - The first American spaceship to visit Station since the Space Shuttle; it is designed to bring people and supplies

ESA - The short form of 'European Space Agency'

FGB - Acronym describing the very first piece of the Space Station, launched by Russia in November 1998 (see 'Zarya')

HTV - H-2B (also known as 'Hope') Transfer Vehicle; the Japanese spaceship that is designed to bring supplies to the Station

JAXA - The short form of 'Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency'

KIBO - Name given to Japan's laboratory module, it means 'hope' in Japanese

LEONARDO - Name given to the European cargo container converted to be a Station module, in honor of Leonardo da Vinci

LOW EARTH ORBIT - What we call the distance above the Earth's surface just beyond the atmosphere; that's where Station is!

MIR - Russian for 'peace'; it was the name of the first Russian space station, which orbited Earth from 1986 to 2001

MPLM - Name (short for MultiPurpose Logistics Module) given to very large containers for experiments and supplies

MULTIPURPOSE LOGISTICS MODULE - See 'MPLM'; four of these were brought to and from the Station by the Space Shuttle

NASA - The short form of 'National Aeronautics and Space Administration' (America's space agency)

NODE - One of three hubs or connecting modules, each used on Station to attach several other modules together

PMA - Name (short for 'Pressurized Mating Adapter') given to the piece that allows spaceships to dock to Station

PRESSURIZED MATING ADAPTER - See 'PMA'; these special tunnel-like pieces allow people and supplies to move through them

PROGRESS - Name given to the Russian spaceship that brings supplies and fuel to the Space Station

QUEST - Name given to America's module that allows space-suited astronauts to leave and enter Station (see 'Airlock')

RADIATOR - Special parts that unfold and are designed to release heat into the coldness of space so Station doesn't overheat

RESEARCH - Collecting data and figuring out what it means, as a way of trying to understand better how things work

ROSCOSMOS - Name given to Russia's space agency

SCIENCE - Observing, studying, and experimenting to learn about how the universe and everything in it works

SERVICE MODULE - Russian module which is both a lab and Station's engine; it keeps Station going fast enough to stay in orbit

SKYLAB - Name given to America's first space station, which orbited Earth from 1973 to 1979

SOLAR ARRAY - Special parts that unfold and are designed to use the sun's energy to make electricity to power the Station

SOYUZ - Russian for 'union'; it is the name of Russia's spaceship that carries people to the Space Station and back again

SPACE SHUTTLE - American spaceship, now retired, used to launch most of the Station's pieces, as well as people and supplies

TRUSS SEGMENT - Part of the giant beam (or 'truss') which connects the solar arrays and radiators to the rest of Station

US LAB - The short form of 'United States Laboratory,' America's main research module (see 'Destiny')

ZARYA - Russian for 'dawn'; name given to the first piece of Station (see 'FGB')

ZVEZDA - Russian for 'star'; name given to the module that controls the Russian part of Station (see 'Service Module')